

Amazing animals

Earth is teeming with life. Even places inhospitable to humans, such as the deepest oceans or hottest deserts, are alive with extraordinary animals. Wherever on the planet animals live, they have adapted to survive in their habitats.

Birds

Warm-blooded bodies and the power of flight mean that feathered birds have reached more parts of the world than any other group of land-living backboned animals, other than humans.

Golden eagle



Polar bear



Bee hummingbird



Reptiles

Like fish and amphibians, reptiles are cold-blooded, relying on the sun to warm their scaly bodies. They include crocodilians, turtles, lizards, and snakes.

Marine iguana



King cobra



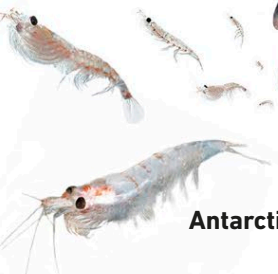
Variety of life

Animals are classified into major groups with shared characteristics: invertebrates, fish, amphibians, reptiles, birds, and mammals. Some of these groups contain more species than others, but all are represented around the world. Some are more widespread than others, too: invertebrates exist almost everywhere, but reptiles do not inhabit the coldest places and amphibians do not reach remote islands.

Adélie penguin



Antarctic krill



Housefly



Common toad

